

Data Validation

Learning Objectives

- Set validation rules for data entry in cells
- Create dropdown lists for restricted choices
- Display error messages for invalid entries

Engage (5-7 minutes)

Think of a temple bell that only rings when pulled correctly—if you push it, nothing happens. Data validation is like that—it prevents wrong data from being entered. You set rules, and the spreadsheet rejects entries that don't follow them.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Select column B (Marks). Go to Data > Validity. Set criteria: Whole Number, between 0 and 100. Try entering 150—see the error message. Now create a dropdown list for Gender column with options: Male, Female, Other. Test the dropdown by selecting from the list.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

Data validation controls what users can enter in cells. You can restrict to numbers within a range, dates, text length, or create dropdown lists from predefined options. Custom error messages guide users when they enter wrong data. This prevents errors and maintains data quality in shared spreadsheets.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Create a health record spreadsheet. Add validation: Age must be 5-100, Weight must be 20-100 kg, Blood Group must be from a dropdown (A+, B+, O+, AB+). Test each validation by trying invalid entries. Write custom error messages for each rule. Verify all validations work correctly.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Answer: Why is data validation important in shared spreadsheets? Create a validation rule for phone numbers (10 digits). What happens when you paste data into validated cells?